

Module 5

Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)

Learning objectives

- Turn your test, coverage, and environment designs into a ****robust regression system**** that scales:....

Prerequisites

- See module README

Learning path

Learning Path

Diagram: Learning Path

(render with mmdc when available)

flowchart LR

T1["Concrete Regression Flows"]

T2["Advanced UVM Orchestration ("]

T1 --> T2

T3["Flake Management and Stabili"]

T2 --> T3

Turn your test, coverage, and environment designs into a **robust regression system** that scales: advanced sequence orchestration (includi...

Overview

- Modules 1–4 established **what to test**, **how to measure**, and **how to build a solid UVM enviro...**

Design architecture

1. Regression system architecture

- Local quick loops, CI gated merges, optional farm for long suites (`REGRESSION\_OPS.md`).
- Regression launcher selects tier
→ test list → seeds → coverage merge → report artifacts.

Rtl Architecture

```
Diagram: Rtl Architecture
(render with mmdc when available)
flowchart TB
    subgraph DUT["stream_fifo (common_dut/rtl)"]
        SRC["Source interface\ns_valid / s_ready / s_data"]
        MEM["Circular buffer\nmem[DEPTH], wr_ptr, rd_ptr"]
        SNK["Sink interface\nm_valid / m_ready / m_data"]
        STS["Status\nlevel, overflow, underflow"]
    end
```

2. Advanced UVM orchestration

- Virtual sequences coordinate multiple agents (e.g., concurrent source/sink traffic).
- Callbacks and config DB patterns for mode switches without rewriting tests.
- Documented in
`ADVANCED\_UVM\_PLAN.md`;
implemented under
`common\_dut/tb/`.

```
Verification Architecture  
  
Diagram: Verification Architecture  
(render with mmdc when available)  
flowchart TB  
  subgraph OPS["Regression operations"]  
    LOCAL["Local runs"]  
    CI["CI pipeline"]  
    FARM["Farm / batch (optional)"]  
  end  
end
```


Monitor — analysis port

```
class stream_monitor extends uvm_component;

    `uvm_component_utils(stream_monitor)

    virtual stream_if.slave vif;
    uvm_analysis_port #(stream_item) ap;

    function new(string name, uvm_component parent);
        super.new(name, parent);
        ap = new("ap", this);
    endfunction

    task run_phase(uvm_phase phase);
        stream_item tr;

        if (vif == null) begin
            # ...
```

stream_test — run_phase

```
class stream_test extends uvm_test;

    `uvm_component_utils(stream_test)

    stream_env env;

    function new(string name, uvm_component parent);
        super.new(name, parent);
    endfunction

    function void build_phase(uvm_phase phase);
        super.build_phase(phase);
        env = stream_env::type_id::create("env", this);
    endfunction

    task run_phase(uvm_phase phase);

# ...
```

Verification & testing methods

1. Operational regression testing

- Every tier has target runtime, pass criteria, and artifact retention (logs, waves, coverage DB).
- Failures triaged with reproducible seeds and minimized waveforms.

Testing Methods

Diagram: Testing Methods

(render with mmdc when available)

flowchart TD

TIER["Regression tier"] --> RUN["Execute suite"]

RUN --> COV["Collect coverage + logs"]

RUN --> FLAKE["Flake detection"]

FLAKE --> DEBUG["DEBUG_FLAKE_PLAN.md triage"]

COV --> PRIOR["Prioritize gaps / failures"]

2. Flake and performance management

- ``DEBUG_FLAKE_PLAN.md`` — detect flaky tests, quarantine policy, timeout budgets.
- Performance tuning: parallel jobs, test ordering, and dropping redundant long tests.

3. Data-driven refinement

- Use regression + coverage history to prioritize new tests and retire low-value ones.
- ``./scripts/module5.sh --check`` validates ops and advanced-UVM planning docs.

Syllabus topics

1. Concrete Regression Flows (1/2)

- Local vs CI vs Farm
- Developer “inner loop” (fast, focused subsets).
- CI per-commit/per-PR runs (sanity + selected CORE tests).
- Nightly/weekly farm runs (CORE/STRESS/FULL tiers).
- Command-Line Interfaces
- Standardizing make/pytest/regression wrapper interfaces.

1. Concrete Regression Flows (2/2)

- Passing seeds, tiers, and configuration via plusargs/env/CLI options.
- Job Definitions
- Defining named regression jobs (e.g., `sanity`, `core\_nightly`, `stress\_weekly`).
- Mapping jobs to tiers, test lists, and resource limits.

2. Advanced UVM Orchestration (Virtual Sequences & Multi-Agent) (1/2)

- Virtual Sequencers & Virtual Sequences
- Coordinating multiple agents (e.g., data + control + sideband).
- Layered sequences that correspond to system-level scenarios.
- Mapping to Test Plan
- Mapping high-level test intents to virtual sequences.
- Using virtual sequences to implement complex scenarios (reset-in-flight, multi-channel flows).

2. Advanced UVM Orchestration (Virtual Sequences & Multi-Agent) (2/2)

- Configuration & Callbacks
- Using complex configuration objects to parameterize regressions.
- Using callbacks to inject debug behavior or temporary instrumentation.

3. Flake Management and Stability (1/2)

- Flaky Test Identification
- Signals of flakiness (non-deterministic failures, timeouts).
- Logging and metadata needed to diagnose flakiness (test ID, seed, environment).
- Policies
- Criteria for marking a test as flaky.
- Temporary quarantine vs immediate fix.

3. Flake Management and Stability (2/2)

- Automatic rerun strategies (e.g., N-of-M reruns to confirm flakiness).
- Designing Flake-Resistant Tests
- Avoiding hidden dependencies on timing or environment.
- Ensuring proper resets and deterministic seeding.

4. Debug & Observability Strategy (1/2)

- Logging
- Standardized log formats (prefixes, IDs, levels).
- Per-test log collection and retention policies.
- Waveforms and Traces
- When to dump waves (always for failures, selectively for passes).
- How to configure trace windows (e.g., last N microseconds before failure).

4. Debug & Observability Strategy (2/2)

- Failure Triage Workflow
- Quick checks (assertion vs scoreboard vs timeout).
- Reproduction steps (same test, same seed, smaller subset).

5. Performance and Scalability (1/2)

- Bottleneck Identification
- Longest-running tests and why.
- Hot spots in sequences, drivers, or reference models.
- Optimization Strategies
- Reducing redundant work (e.g., fewer warm-up cycles, targeted stress).
- Using configuration to scale test depth per tier.

5. Performance and Scalability (2/2)

- Regression Capacity Planning
- Estimating how many tests can run per hour/day.
- Planning parallelism and job sharding.

6. Coverage-Driven Regression Refinement

- Using Coverage to Shape Regressions
- Prioritizing tests that contribute most to coverage gaps.
- Designing “closure suites” for specific coverage areas.
- Bug-Driven Refinement
- Using bug history to prioritize tests and sequences.
- Ensuring that fixed bugs get regression tests and coverage.

Hands-on examples

Module 5 self-check

```
$ ./scripts/module5.sh --help
```

Terminal: module5_check

```
[[0;36m=====[[0m
[[0;36mModule 5: Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration[[0m
[[0;36m=====[[0m
```

Usage: ./scripts/module5.sh [OPTIONS]

Module 5: Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)
This script summarizes and checks the planning artifacts for Module 5.

OPTIONS:

--regression-status	Show status of regression_ops.md only
--uvm-status	Show status of advanced_uvm_plan.md only
--debug-status	Show status of debug_flake_plan.md only
--checklist-status	Show status of checklist_module5.md only
--summary	Show all statuses (default)
--check	Media/CI self-check (structure only)
--demo	Print example commands from EXAMPLES.md
--scaffold	Copy templates/*.md into module5/ if missing
--help, -h	Show this help message

EXAMPLES:

```
# Full summary
./scripts/module5.sh

# Focus only on regression operations
./scripts/module5.sh --regression-status
```

Exercise scaffold

```
./scripts/module5.sh --scaffold
```

Demo: Regression operations template

```
$ head -30 module5/templates/REGRESSION_OPS.md
```

Terminal: ex01_regression_ops

Regression Operations (Module 5)

> **Purpose**: Define concrete regression flows, commands, and CI/farm integration.

> **Module**: 5 – Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)

> **Instructions**: Fill in this document for your design. Copy from `module5/templates/` if nee

1. Context

<!-- TODO: DUT/Project, primary simulator(s), earlier plans (tiers, coverage, env). -->

2. Regression Jobs

<!-- TODO: Table of Job Name, Description, Tier(s), Approx Runtime, Intended Use. -->

3. Command-Line Interfaces

3.1 Local (Developer) Usage

<!-- TODO: Example commands (run_regression.sh or equivalent), options, environment variables. -

3.2 CI / Farm Usage

<!-- TODO: CI/farm integration, job definitions (YAML etc.), parameters. -->

4. Test Selection Rules

<!-- TODO: How each job chooses tests (by tier, ID, tag). Link to module2/TEST_PLAN.md. -->

5. Seeds and Randomization at Regression Level

Demo: Debug and flake plan

```
$ head -25 module5/templates/DEBUG_FLAKE_PLAN.md
```

Terminal: ex02_debug_flake

Debug, Flakiness & Performance Plan (Module 5)

> **Purpose**: Define how you will detect, debug, and manage flaky tests, as well as monitor and
> **Module**: 5 – Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)

> **Instructions**: Fill in this document for your design. Copy from `module5/templates/` if nee

1. Flake Definition and Detection

1.1 What is a Flaky Test Here?

<!-- TODO: Criteria for a test being considered flaky (same test+seed, intermittent, timeout). -

1.2 Detection Signals

<!-- TODO: Signals/heuristics to detect flakiness; how they are monitored (CI, tracking, review)

2. Rerun and Quarantine Policy

2.1 Rerun Strategy

<!-- TODO: How many reruns, under what conditions; decision rules (pass on rerun = flaky, etc.).

2.2 Quarantine Rules

Demo: Advanced UVM plan

```
$ head -25 module5/templates/ADVANCED_UVM_PLAN.md
```

Terminal: ex03_advanced_uvm

```
# Advanced UVM Orchestration Plan (Module 5)
```

```
> **Purpose**: Plan how advanced UVM features (virtual sequences, virtual sequencers, complex co  
> **Module**: 5 - Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)
```

```
> **Instructions**: Fill in this document for your design. Copy from `module5/templates/` if nee
```

```
## 1. Context
```

```
<!-- TODO: DUT/System composition, agents/interfaces, related docs. Which advanced UVM features
```

```
## 2. Virtual Sequencer and Virtual Sequences
```

```
### 2.1 Virtual Sequencer Design
```

```
<!-- TODO: Table of Virtual Sequencer, Sequencers Controlled, Purpose/Scope. Placement and bindi
```

```
### 2.2 Virtual Sequences and Scenario Mapping
```

```
<!-- TODO: Map virtual sequences to test IDs/scenarios. Phases and coordination. -->
```

```
## 3. Configuration Objects and Hierarchical Config
```

```
<!-- TODO: Table of Config Class, Scope, Key Fields, Notes. Set/propagation/validation. -->
```


Demo: Reference regression ops

```
$ head -20 module5/.solutions/REGRESSION_OPS.md
```

```
Terminal: ex04_solutions
# Regression Operations (Module 5)

> **Purpose**: Define concrete regression flows, commands, and CI/farm integration.
> **Module**: 5 - Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration (SV/UVM)

## 1. Context

- **DUT / Project**: stream_fifo verification (Stream FIFO Verification); common_dut/rtl + modul
- **Primary simulator(s)**: Verilator (or VCS/Questa/Xcelium as available).
- **Earlier plans**:
  - Tiers and goals: `module2/REGRESSION_PLAN.md`
  - Coverage & environment: `module3/COVERAGE_RUN.md`, `module4/ENV_DESIGN.md`

This document turns those plans into **concrete jobs and commands**.

## 2. Regression Jobs

Define named jobs that can be invoked locally or from CI.

| Job Name | Description | Tier(s) | Approx Runtime | Int
```

Demo: Module validation

```
$ ./scripts/module5.sh --check
```

Terminal: ex05_validate

```
███0;36m=====███0m
███0;36mModule 5: Regression Management & Advanced UVM Orchestration███0m
███0;36m=====███0m
```

Module 5: media self-check
OK: module5/ exists
OK: templates/ exists
OK: EXAMPLES.md exists
OK: docs/MODULE5.md exists
OK: common_dut/rtl/ exists

All required checks passed.

Practice & assessment

What you should know (1/5)

- Define and run repeatable regression flows across local and CI/farm environments.
- Use virtual sequences and advanced UVM patterns to orchestrate complex scenarios.
- Detect, triage, and manage flaky tests and instability in regressions.
- Implement a practical debug and observability strategy (logs, waves, metadata).
- Use coverage and bug data to prioritize and refine regression content.
- In ``module5/REGRESSION_OPS.md``, define at least:

What you should know (2/5)

- A `sanity` job (fast, per-commit).
- A `core\_nightly` job.
- A `stress\_weekly` or `full\_release` job.
- For each job, specify:
- Tier(s), test selection rules, expected runtime, and invocation commands.
- In `module5/ADVANCED\_UVM\_PLAN.md`, map several high-level tests to:

What you should know (3/5)

- Specific virtual sequences and their participating agents/sequencers.
- Key configuration parameters (modes, seeds, error-injection toggles).
- Identify at least 3 scenarios that require multi-agent coordination.
- In ``module5/DEBUG_FLAKE_PLAN.md``, define:
- What constitutes a flake in your context.
- How many reruns you perform to confirm flakiness.

What you should know (4/5)

- How you quarantine and track flaky tests.
- How/when they must be fixed before sign-off.
- Define:
- Standard log naming and locations.
- When and how to generate waveforms.
- Minimum metadata required in failure reports (test ID, seed, tier, DUT hash).

What you should know (5/5)

- Verify on at least one failing test that you can reproduce and debug using these artifacts.

Exercises

- Runtime Tuning
- Coverage-Driven Job
- Resilience Drill

Assessment checklist

- Concrete regression jobs and commands captured in
`module5/REGRESSION\_OPS.md`.
- Virtual sequence and advanced UVM usage planned in
`module5/ADVANCED\_UVM\_PLAN.md`.
- Flake and debug strategy documented in
`module5/DEBUG\_FLAKE\_PLAN.md`.
- Regression flows demonstrably support coverage and
sign-off goals.

Summary & next steps

- Turn your test, coverage, and environment designs into a ****robust regression system**** that scales:....
- Complete module5/CHECKLIST.md
- Review module5/EXAMPLES.md and run each lab
- Next: Next module in course